

Blocks and Columns

S. Liang

March 2026

Three kinds of block

Definition

A frame is the unit of a presentation; a slide is one overlay of a frame.

Caution

The frame counter and the page counter differ as soon as a frame has more than one slide.

Example

A frame with two `\pause` commands has three slides.

Two columns

Left column, aligned at the top.
This text is long enough to wrap inside its column so that the column width can be measured.

- ▶ first point
- ▶ second point

Right column, also top-aligned, with a block inside it.

In a column

Blocks take the width of the column that contains them.

A graphic

$$x = \frac{-b \pm \sqrt{b^2 - 4ac}}{2a}$$

The image is scaled to six tenths of the text width and centred.

A table

stage	time (ms)	share
parse	12	8 %
shape	95	63 %
break	31	21 %
export	12	8 %

Table: Time per stage for a ten-page document.

A footnote

Beamer puts footnotes at the bottom of the frame,¹ not at the bottom of the paper.

Blocks and columns together

narrow

wide, with more text than the narrow
column so it wraps

¹Above the footline, if the theme has one.